

1900 ▶ 1905

1900

Zeppelin airship takes off

The Zeppelin LZ1 made its first flight from Lake Constance, Germany. It was the first airship built around a rigid structure—in this case, a light but strong aluminum frame covered with cotton cloth. Inside, hydrogen gas in 17 rubberized cotton cells provided lift. Two aluminum gondolas hung below the 420-ft- (128-m-) long airship to carry crew and passengers.

First flight of the LZ1



Booth's vacuum cleaner, pulled by a horse

1901

First powered suction vacuum cleaner

Built by English engineer Hubert Cecil Booth, this giant vacuum cleaner was powered by an internal combustion engine. A piston pump inside it drew air through pipes past a cloth filter, which collected dust and dirt. The device was parked outside houses and flexible pipes fed in through doors and windows.

1901

Blood groups

The first major blood groups, or types—A, B, and O—were identified by Austrian biologist Karl Landsteiner. He discovered that mixing blood of two different types caused red blood cells to clump together and stop working, while mixing blood of the same type did not. This enabled doctors to prepare safer, more effective blood transfusions.

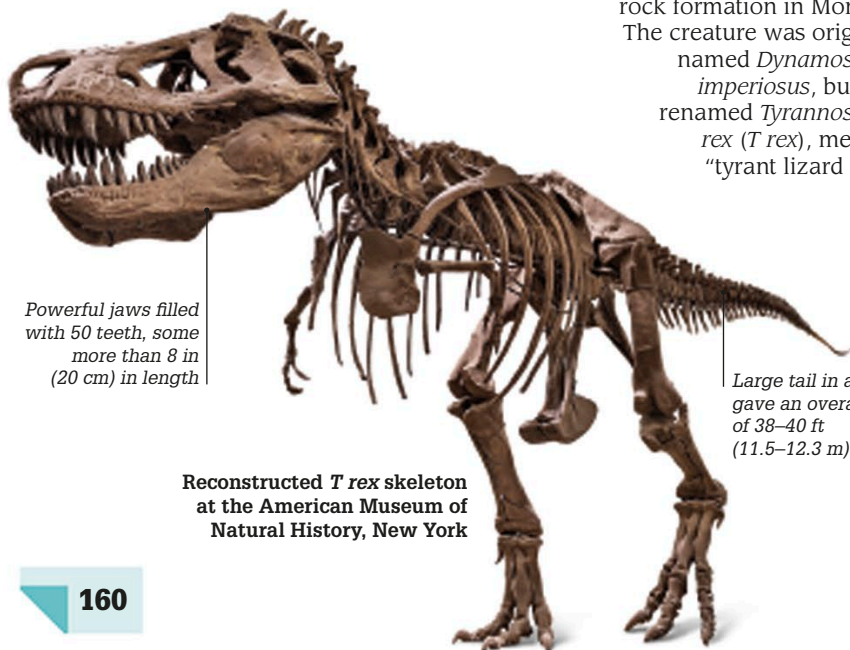
1900

“... its size greatly exceeds any carnivorous land animal hitherto described.”

Henry Fairfield Osborn
on the *Tyrannosaurus rex*, 1905

Tyrannosaurus rex

American paleontologist Barnum Brown discovered the fossil remains of a large, two-legged, meat-eating dinosaur in the Hell's Creek rock formation in Montana. The creature was originally named *Dynamosaurus imperiosus*, but later renamed *Tyrannosaurus rex* (*T rex*), meaning “tyrant lizard king.”



Powerful jaws filled with 50 teeth, some more than 8 in (20 cm) in length

Large tail in an adult gave an overall length of 38–40 ft (11.5–12.3 m)

Reconstructed *T rex* skeleton at the American Museum of Natural History, New York

1902

Tyrannosaurus rex

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1902

Layers of the atmosphere

After a decade of research using more than 200 weather balloons, French meteorologist Léon Teisserenc de Bort described and defined accurately the lowest two layers of Earth's atmosphere. The troposphere extends from ground level up to an average altitude of 6.2 miles (10 km) while the stratosphere is found between heights of 6.2 miles (10 km) and 31 miles (50 km).

Temperature decreases with increasing altitude in the troposphere.

The boundary between the two layers is called the tropopause.

Stratosphere
Troposphere

